

"IT'S A JOURNEY OF EMPOWERING EVERY CITIZEN OF ODISHA"

dia as a postcard of poverty and malnutrition. But now this region is scaling new peaks of development every day, emerging as a rice bowl of the country.

We have managed to reduce multidimensional poverty in Odisha by 48 per cent in the last decade alone. More than one crore people escaped poverty during this period. From a ship-to-mouth situation, we have come a long way to become the third largest contributor to the nation's public distribution system (PDS).

From a non-existent player in a sports ecosystem, Odisha has emerged as a model in sports development. We are building an enviable sports ecosystem in the country. When our national hockey teams reached the podium after more than four decades in the Olympics, Odisha also basked in the glory of the nation with its partnership.

Today, Odisha has emerged as a unique model in women empowerment. After empowering our women under Mission Shakti, we are embarking on a new journey to make them entrepreneurs. Our party is one of the pioneers in women empowerment, reserving one-third seats for women in the 2019 Lok Sabha election. More than 50 per cent of women are getting elected to grassroots democratic institutions.

"TODAY, AS WE STAND AT THE CUSP OF A NEW ERA, LET US RE-COMMIT OURSELVES TO BUILDING A NEW ODISHA BY 2036"

With Biju Swasthya Kalyan Yojana, we have ensured that even the poorest person is not scared by the cost of treatment. Our transformed classrooms with modern facilities and technologies have added wings to the dreams of our future citizens and encouraged them to dream big.

When we embarked on this journey of transformation, we made people partners in progress. Banking on the principles of 5T (transparency, technology, teamwork, time limit, and transformation), our singular vision is: A New Odisha, an Empowered Odisha. The vision of Empowered Odisha means that, in Odisha, poverty will be a thing of the past, women will be equal partners in growth and development, the landscape of development will be inclusive of all vulnerable sections and dreams of the youth will come true.

Our transformative journey is a journey of empowerment for each and every individual of Odisha.

Today, as we stand at the cusp of a new era, let us re-commit ourselves to building a New Odisha by 2036 that will be a guiding light to the entire nation on empowerment. ■